

Keep Stress At Bay with Vehicle Tracking Systems

► **Manage your vehicles better while keeping an eye out for any kind of nuisance like fuel theft.**

In 2012, Arjun S. Kumar, then 13-year-old school student from Chennai, was caught in a cyclone-induced heavy rain while returning home by the school bus, leaving his parents worried about his whereabouts and wellbeing. To help parents in such situations, the boy later went on to program a mobile application called Locatera, which helps school authorities and parents to track a school bus, get information on the students available in the bus and know whereabouts of the bus at any given time. Interestingly, this app, developed by a school student, has been acknowledged by the government of India, the Massachusetts



School bus tracking solutions (Image courtesy: Pixabay website)

Institute of Technology (MIT) and Google. Fortunately, there are a host of similar solutions available today. Here we talk about a few of them.

Scope of the technology

Apart from educational institutions like schools and colleges that provide transport services to their students, transport companies that often partner with hospitality majors can boost their business using bus tracking applications.

Creating a brand value. For any player in the transport business, safety is the biggest concern. Thus, when safety is assured, the brand value of the transport company goes several notches up. And this is exactly the USP of this technology. The application helps track a vehicle's movements in real time—including location, speed, direction and so on. Tabs on the driver's behavioural patterns like punctuality, driving style and route regulations keep both the company as well as customers informed about the reliability of the driver. In addition,

there are panic buttons to raise emergency alerts.

Trans Global Geomatics, a Hyderabad-based fleet management solutions company, has provided a school-bus tracking solution for International School, Kakinada, which manages 40 buses. There were reports of frequent school bus delays during pickup. Additionally, the management suspected fuel theft from the buses, noticing unavailability of the vehicles at times.

Trans Global Geomatics provided the school a bus tracking solution, which gave users insight like vehicle idle alert (SMS- and email-based notification for every five-minute halt), real-time bus navigation tracking to monitor the whereabouts of the bus, details on every halt made by the bus throughout the day, and daily pickup and drop-off data. All this data helped the school authority to manage their vehicles better while keeping an eye out for any kind of nuisance like fuel theft.

Saving money. Be it an organisation's own fleet of buses or a third-party transport company, cost efficiency

Smarter India



Internet on Flights Soon in India

In a year's time, Indian flyers should be able to access the Internet during their flight—according to BSNL.



Mobile App for Taxpayers

Titled 'My Tax,' the app developed by the Income Tax department is aimed to help taxpayers get all the relevant information and interact with the department too.



Hi-tech Helmets for Indian Army

The Indian Army has received a new lot of high-tech helmets called Commander Helmets, which have an inbuilt communication device and are compatible with different radio sets.